

Chris J Shanku

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Summary

I spent 8 years at Microsoft selling AI. Now I build it - for the life I almost lost.

Experience

Senior Director, FSI Practice, iLink Digital (2025 - present)

Building iLink's US FSI practice: consultative pre-sales, Microsoft co-sell, and the AI tools the team sells with.

Solutions Engineer → Sales, Financial Services, Microsoft (2017 - 2025)

8 years selling AI and data into financial services: five in technical pre-sales, three in Data & AI sales for banking.

Ventures

The Grove (Personal LifeOS · Multi-agent)

The LifeOS I built for my family and me. thegrove.pro

Human in the Loop (Media · LinkedIn Live · Every Friday)

A live show about AI, built with AI. 15 episodes. humanintheloop.stream

iLink Tools (AI tools for an FSI sales team)

Tools I built with agents so my team sells smarter. 16 tools built. ilink.tools

Selected tools: Frontier Forge (forge.ilink.tools), Fieldline (fieldline.ilink.tools), WireDesk (wiredesk.ilink.tools).

SignalScope graduated into WayFact.

twelfth.help (Recovery · Daily delivery)

Carrying the message to the person who needs it. twelfth.help

WayFact (FSI data curation)

FSI data curation, from signal to fact. Status: private beta

Skills

Agents & AI: Multi-agent orchestration, RAG architectures, Azure OpenAI, Anthropic Claude, LangChain

Data & Backend: Python, FastAPI, Postgres + pgvector, Microsoft Fabric, Power BI

Cloud & Infra: Azure, Microsoft 365, Docker, Proxmox homelab, GitHub Actions

GTM & Storytelling: FSI go-to-market, Executive briefings, Keynote speaking, The Moth storytelling

Updated 2026-07-16 · <https://shanku.net/resume/>